

IMAGES IN CLINICAL MEDICINE

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Leukemia Cutis



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A 65-YEAR-OLD MAN PRESENTED TO THE DERMATOLOGY CLINIC WITH A 5-day history of a painful rash on his hands and elbows. He had no other symptoms. Physical examination showed erythematous and purplish plaques on the dorsa of both hands and elbows in a symmetric distribution. Laboratory examinations showed a white-cell count of 16,000 per cubic millimeter (reference range, 4200 to 10,200) and a platelet count of 70,000 per cubic millimeter (reference range, 145,00 to 348,000). Skin biopsy of a lesion on the left elbow revealed a perivascular lymphocytic infiltrate in the dermis, with positive staining for myeloperoxidase, CD123, Ki67, and CD68. A diagnosis of leukemia cutis was made, and the patient was urgently referred to the oncology clinic. A bone marrow biopsy revealed 15 to 20% blasts and molecular mutations in *ASXL1*, *NRAS*, *SRSF2*, and *TET2*. The patient received a diagnosis of chronic myelomonocytic leukemia and underwent stem-cell transplantation. Two weeks after the transplantation, the patient's skin changes had resolved, and the cancer has been in remission since.

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